

Management of Medication Policy

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER Principal / Key Management Personnel	APPROVED BY Governing body
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PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy explains how [] supports participants with medication — how self-administration is supported, how trained workers administer medication safely from the original packaging in accordance with the prescriber's directions, and how medication is recorded, reviewed, stored and disposed of.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [] to apply the Management of Medication NDIS Practice Standard. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[] is committed to ensuring that:

- records clearly identify the medication and dosage required by each participant, and all information needed to correctly identify the participant and safely administer the medication;
- all workers responsible for administering medication understand its effects and side effects and the steps to take in a medication incident; and
- all medications are stored safely and securely, are easily identified and differentiated, and are only accessed by appropriately trained workers.

3. Self-administration

Participants manage and administer their own medication where appropriate. Where required, the Principal requests written advice from the participant's medical practitioner or guardian confirming the participant has the training and skill to take responsibility for their own medication. Self-administration is supervised, documented and recorded by workers, and every opportunity is provided for the participant to safely manage their own medication.

4. Administration by workers

Where a participant cannot self-administer, workers provide whatever physical or other assistance is necessary and appropriate to enable the participant to take their own medication, unless the participant objects. Workers who administer medication are trained by a registered training organisation in medication administration (for example HLTHPS006 *Assist clients with medication* or equivalent).

All medication is administered in strict accordance with the directions of the prescribing practitioner or the manufacturer, recorded on the medication chart, and taken or administered from the original containers or

packages in which it was dispensed. Medication is never given to a participant by another participant.

5. Prohibited practices

Workers must not: administer any medication not prescribed in accordance with this policy (including over-the-counter medication); administer medication to a participant who is clearly objecting in an informed manner, unless an approved protocol is in place; administer medication in a manner that is for organisational convenience rather than the participant's preference or needs; or leave medication unsupervised and accessible to participants or unauthorised people.

6. Records, review, storage and disposal

A medication chart is maintained for each participant prescribed medication, completed by the participant's medical officer and updated whenever a medication changes; any uncertainty is clarified immediately with the participant's GP or dispensing pharmacist. [] uses reasonable endeavours to ensure each participant's medications are reviewed with their medical practitioner at least annually.

Medication is stored in a secure, lockable location in original packaging or a dose administration aid, in accordance with the manufacturer's and prescriber's storage requirements, and in an appropriate container when transported. When ceased, all medication (including self-administered) is returned to the pharmacist or the participant; no prescription-only medication is kept as stock or shared between participants.

7. Reporting

Medication incidents are reported under the Incident Management and Reporting Policy, including completing an Incident Report Form and updating the Incident Register.

8. Definitions

[]

[], ABN [].

Client

A client of [], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[], and other key management personnel involved in [] from time to time.

Principal

[].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [], including the Principal.

9. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Administering Medication Checklist / Medication Chart · Services Medication and Participant Details · Collection / Storage of Medicine Register · Incident Management and Reporting Policy · Client Support Plan · Legislation Register · Policy Register.

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	
Approval date	
Next scheduled review	
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